DO YOU KNOW?

To measure the volume of liquids, some other units are also used. Some of them are gallon, ounce, and quart.

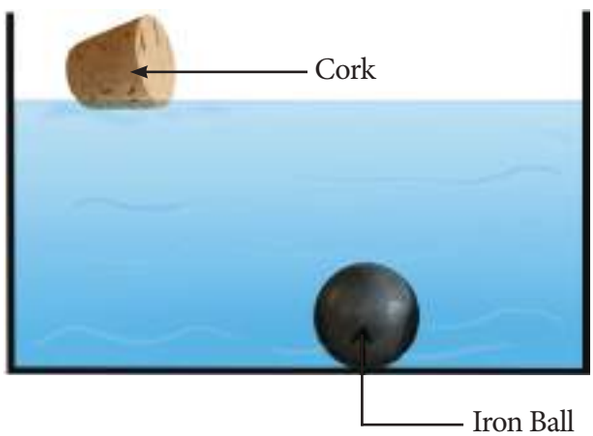
1 gallon = 3785 ml

1 ounce = 30 ml

1 quart = 1 litre

1.4 Density

Take water in a beaker and drop an iron ball and a cork into the water. What do you observe? The iron ball sinks and the cork floats as shown in figure. Can you explain why?



Iron ball sinks while cork floats in water

If your answer is heavy objects sink in water and lighter objects float in water, then, why does a metal coin sinks in water whereas a much heavier wooden log floats? These questions can be answered if we understand the concept of density.



Lighter coin sinks while heavier wooden log floats

ACTIVITY 4

a. Take an iron block and a wooden block of same mass (say 1kg each). Measure their volume. Which one has more volume and occupies more volume?
Ans: _____

b. Take an iron block and a wooden block of same size. Weigh them and measure their mass. Which one of them has more mass?
Ans: _____

From activity 4, we observe that wooden block occupies more volume than the iron ball of same mass. Also, we observe that wooden block is lighter than the iron block of same size.

The lightness or heaviness of a body is due to density. If more mass is packed into some volume, it has greater density. So, the iron block will have more mass than the wooden block of the same size. Therefore, iron has more density.

Density of a substance is defined as the mass of the substance contained in unit volume (1 m^3). If the mass of a substance is M and volume is V, then, its density is given as

$$Density\ (D) = \frac{Mass\ (M)}{Volume\ (V)}$$

$$D = \frac{M}{V}$$

SI unit of density is kg/m^3. The CGS unit of density is g/cm^3.

1.4.1 Density of different materials

Different materials have different densities. The materials with more density are called denser and the materials with less density are called rarer. The density of some widely used materials are listed in Table 1.4.

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